



PROCEDURE

Clinical Capacity Management

Scope (Staff):	All NMHS Older Adult Community Mental Health Staff
Scope (Area):	All NMHS Older Adult Community Mental Health Services (Osborne, Lower West and Wanneroo)

1. Aim

This procedure aims to ensure the delivery of safe and efficient clinical services to the community, while managing risks to clients, carers and staff during times of staff shortages or where clinical demand exceeds capacity.

2. Risk

Planning for staff shortages or where clinical demand exceeds capacity, assists the organisation to avoid detrimental outcomes for both clients and staff and ensures appropriate and timely clinical services are delivered to clients, carers and external stakeholders.

Non-compliance with this procedure will impact on the following risk categories:

Culture	☐	Organisational Development	☐
Emergency Management	☐	Policy & Legislative Compliance	☐
Fiscal Responsibility	☐	Quality of Patient Care	☒
Governance & Accountability	☐	Research & Innovation	☐
Information Communications Technology	☐	Staff Safety & Wellness	☒
Facility Management	☐	Workforce Planning	☐
Medical Equipment	☐	Other	☐

3. Definitions

Low Level Risk: defined as, up to 25% of the community workforce absent form work for 1 - 4 days. Clinical services can be managed short-term with available resources.

Medium Level Risk: defined as, up to 25% of the community workforce absent form work for 5 days or more. Clinical services can be managed short-term with available resources.

High Level Risk: defined as, up to 50% of the community workforce absent form work for 1 day or more. Clinical services can be managed short-term with immediate resources in place.

Extreme Risk: **Code Yellow**: defined as, more than 50% of the community workforce absent form work for 1 day or more. Staffing levels deemed unsafe to manage the risk and resources are at crisis point.

NB: these figures are not inclusive of agreed leave numbers.

4. Process

[illegible]

Actions	Responsible Staff
OAMHS Coordinator of Nursing will: • Inform OAMHS Executive Team of nursing shortage contingency risk level. OAMHS Service Manager will: • Redirect SW, OT, Psychology and TSU (Therapy Service Unit) staff to community services for case management and duty officer duties. • Review of caseloads, caseload numbers and redirecting of cases	OAMHS Coordinator of Nursing OAMHS Service Manager
<u>High Level Risk</u> OAMHS Nurse Manager will: • Complete the actions as defined for low level and medium risk. • Contact Nurse Managers at Adult and Forensic services to source staff. OAMHS Clinical Nurse Specialist/Manager will: • Complete the actions as defined for low level and medium risk. • Activate the traffic light system for prioritising care delivery. OAMHS Coordinator of Nursing will: • Complete the actions as defined for low level and medium risk. OAMHS Service Manager will: • Complete the actions as defined for low level and medium risk. OAMHS site Head of Service will: • Liaise with the medical staff to prioritise referred clients against acuity and risk. • Instigate waitlists for initial assessments and maintenance of waitlists (with a risk assessment component built into it).	OAMHS Nurse Manager OAMHS Clinical Nurse Specialist / Manager (Community) OAMHS Co-ordinator of Nursing OAMHS Service Manager OAMHS site Head of Service

Actions	Responsible Staff
Extreme Risk – Code Yellow (internal staffing shortage) OAMHS Nurse Manager will: • Complete the actions as defined for low level, medium and high risk. • Liaise with members of the Emergency Response Team (ERT). OAMHS Clinical Nurse Specialist/Manager will: • Complete the actions as defined for low, medium and high risk. OAMHS Coordinator of Nursing will: • Complete the actions as defined for low, medium and high risk. • In liaison with the Executive team consider implementing a single point of entry to the service but directing all triage, referral and bed flow issues to the duty office at another OAMHS community site co-located with an Older Adult in- patient unit (Lower West or Osborne Community team). OAMHS site Head of Service will: • Complete the actions as defined for low, medium and high risk. OAMHS Service Manager will: • Complete the actions as defined for low level, medium and high risk. • Contact Service Managers at Adult and Forensic Services to source staff. Emergency Response Team will: Report to Emergency Control Group as per the Business Continuity Plan (BCP)	OAMHS Nurse Manager OAMHS Clinical Nurse Specialist / Manager (Community) OAMHS Coordinator of Nursing OAMHS site Head of Service OAMHS Service Manager Emergency Response Team

5. Compliance, monitoring and evaluation

Effectiveness of this policy and evaluation of intended outcomes is monitored by:

- Presentation of referral response statistics at the monthly Community Advisory Committee (CAC) and Admitted Advisory Committee (AAC).
- Emergency Response activations

Related internal policies, procedures and guidelines
MH Clinical Risk Assessment and Management (CRAM) Policy DoH Clinical Handover

References
Triage to Discharge: Mental Health Framework for State-wide Standardised Clinical Documentation 'Triage to Discharge'

Policy Sponsor	Co-Director MH Specialties				
Policy Contact	Clinical Nurse Manager OAMHS				
Date First Issued:	27/03/2023	Last Reviewed:	N/A	Review Date:	27/03/2026
Approved by:	Co-Director MH Specialties			Date:	27/03/2023
Endorsed by:	Co-Director MH Specialties			Date:	27/03/2023
NSQHS Standards Applicable:	☒  Std 1: Clinical Governance ☐  Std 2: Partnering with Consumers ☐  Std 3: Preventing and Controlling Healthcare Associated Infection ☐  Std 4: Medication Safety		☐  Std 5: Comprehensive Care ☒  Std 6: Communicating for Safety ☐  Std 7: Blood Management ☐  Std 8: Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration		
National Standards for Mental Health Services	☐ Std 1: Rights and Responsibilities ☐ Std 2: Safety ☐ Std 3: Consumer and Carer Participation ☐ Std 4: Diversity Responsibility ☐ Std 5: Promotion and Prevention ☐ Std 6: Consumers ☐ Std 7: Carers ☐ Std 8: Governance, leadership and management		☐ Std 9: Integration ☐ Std 10: Delivery of Care ☐ 10.1 Supporting Recovery ☐ 10.2 Access ☐ 10.3 Entry ☐ 10.4 Assessment and Review ☐ 10.5 Treatment and Support ☐ 10.6 Exit and Re-entry		
Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care:	Aboriginal Practice, Assessment, Care Planning, Consumer and Carer Involvement in Individual Care, Physical Health Care of Mental Health Consumers, Risk Assessment and Management, Seclusion and Bodily Restraint Reduction, Transfer of Care				
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Document Version Control			
Date	Version	Author	Notes
27/03/2024	1.0	Clinical Nurse Manager OAMHS	Initial endorsement of procedure aimed to ensure the delivery of safe and efficient clinical services to the community, while managing risks to clients, carers and staff during times of stage shortages or where clinical demand exceeds capacity.

The health impact upon Aboriginal people have been considered, and where relevant incorporated and appropriately addressed in the development of this health initiative

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